

Camera calibration checkerboard -- 9 x 6 INNER CORNERS, 25.0 mm squares

board 250.0 x 175.0 mm (10 x 7 squares) | inner-corner span 200.0 x 125.0 mm | page 2 is the board

1. **PRINT SETTINGS. Scale 100% / 'Actual size'. NEVER 'fit to page' or 'shrink oversized pages'.**

Landscape. Duplex OFF. MATTE plain paper -- gloss reflects the light you are calibrating under.

2. **VERIFY THE PRINTER on the bars below BEFORE you mount the board.**

200.0 mm bar and 150.0 mm bar, measured with a steel rule. Out by >1 mm -> fix the dialog and reprint.

3. **MOUNT IT DEAD FLAT. Spray-mount page 2 to foamboard, MDF, or glass -- no bubbles, no bow, no curl.**

After scale, FLATNESS is the dominant calibration error: a 2 mm bow across the board biases the distortion coefficients and the RMS will still look fine. Tape at the corners only is NOT enough.

4. **MEASURE THE BOARD ITSELF (the board is its own ruler -- do this even if you bought a board).**

Outermost inner corner to outermost inner corner: 200.0 mm along the LONG axis, 125.0 mm along the short axis.

Full black extent: 250.0 x 175.0 mm. Divide the long span by 8 to get your ACTUAL square size

and pass THAT to --square. Do not assume the nominal value.

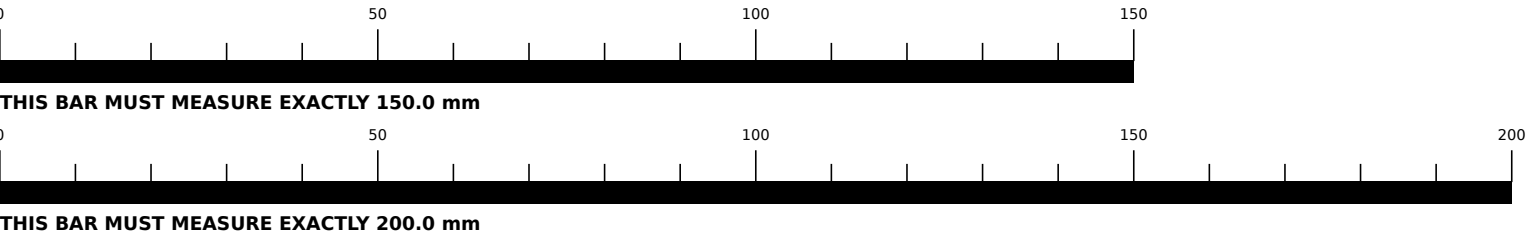
5. **CAPTURE >= 15 views (build_tab skr-06 acceptance: RMS reprojection <= 1.0 px).**

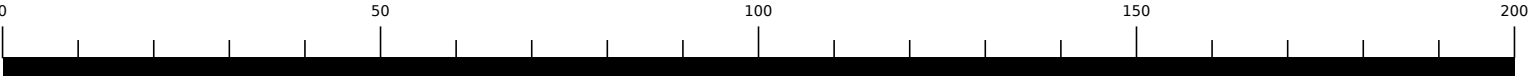
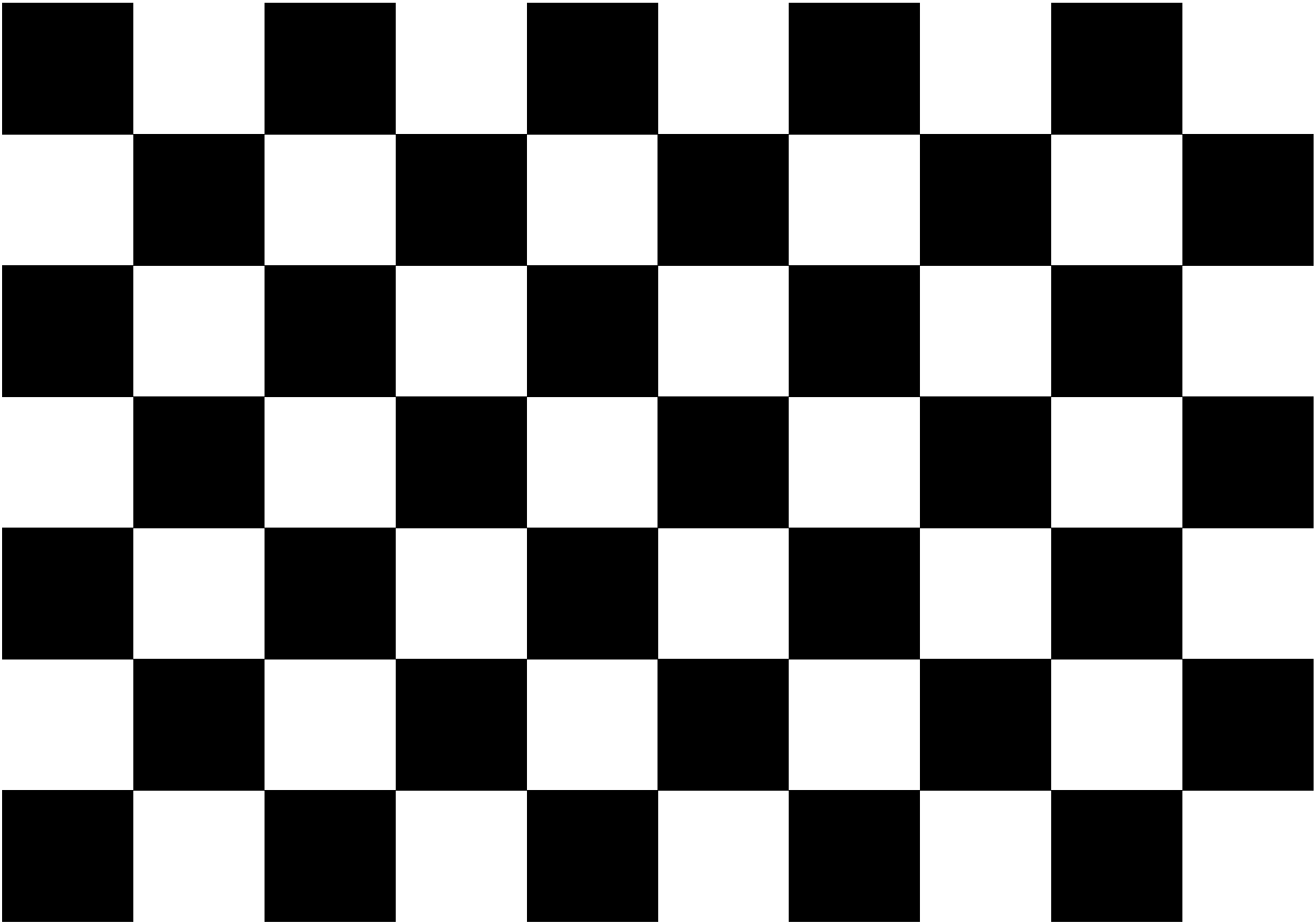
Vary angle, distance and position; fill the corners of the frame, not just the centre; keep the board sharp (it is the LENS you are measuring, not the paper). Shoot in the FINAL tripod geometry, and re-shoot a short set at end of session to catch thermal drift (tripod_test_protocol.md 5).

6. **RUN:**

```
scripts/calibrate_camera.py --images 'calib/*.png' --cols 9 --rows 6 --square 0.025 --out calib.json
```

Every range and bearing the campaign produces is wrong until this passes. A uniform print-scale error is INVISIBLE in the RMS -- it is consistent with itself. The bars in step 2 and the measurement in step 4 are the only things standing between a 3% print error and a 3% error in every number.





SCALE CHECK: exactly 200.0 mm